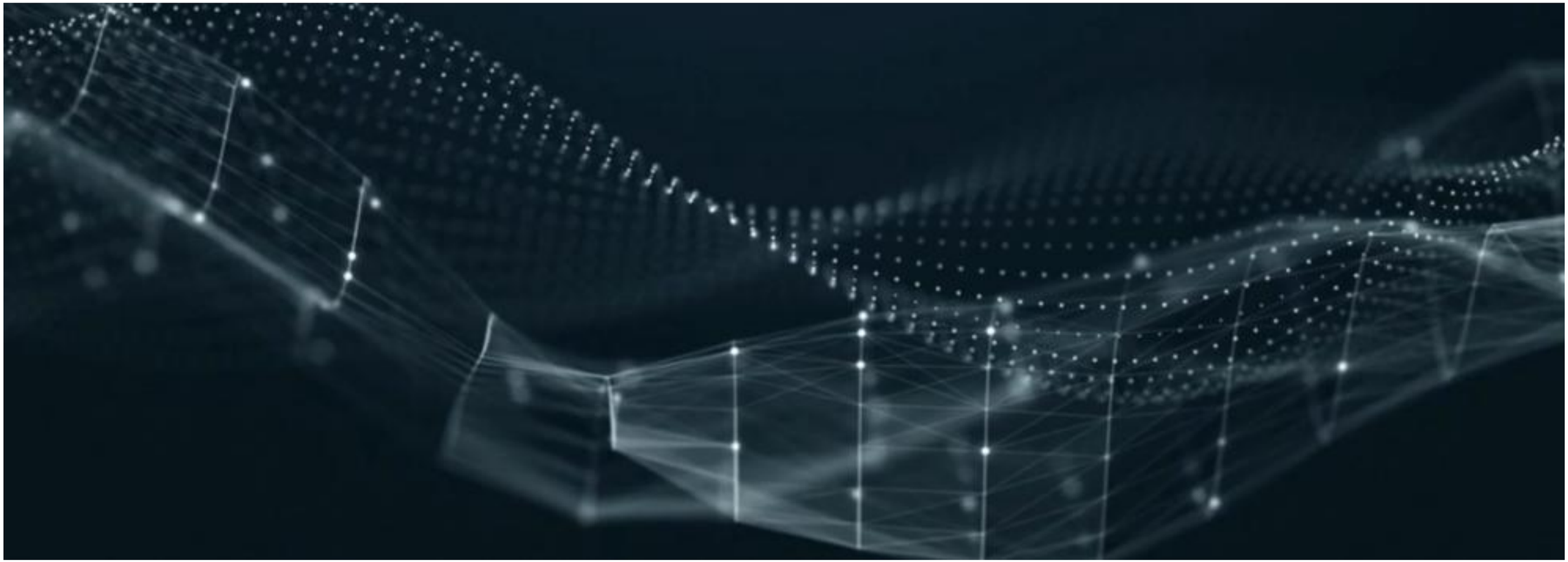
Power

North America Outlook | Week of 9 March 2026

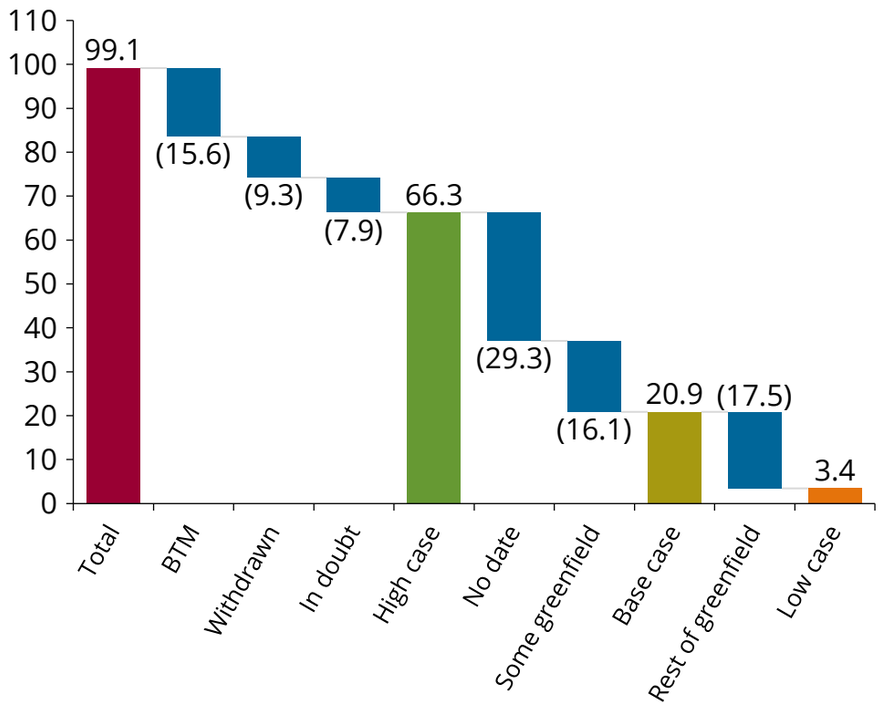
Power and natural gas weekly update



Our PJM load forecast remains weighted towards the lower end of possible scenarios

Planned data-centre nameplate capacity, PJM

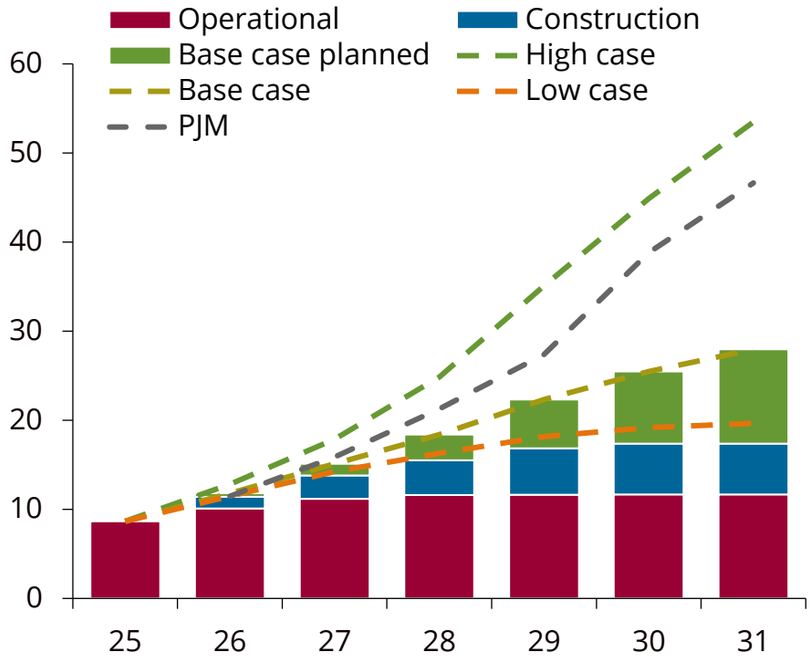
GW



Excluding withdrawn and doubtful projects, we track 66.3 GW of nameplate capacity (net of BTM). Our base case removes no-date projects and discounts greenfield project survival to 25%.

Modelled PJM data-centre demand

GW



Holding operational and construction forecasts constant, our high-planned case aligns with PJM's outlook, while our low-planned case assumes just active sites reach completion.

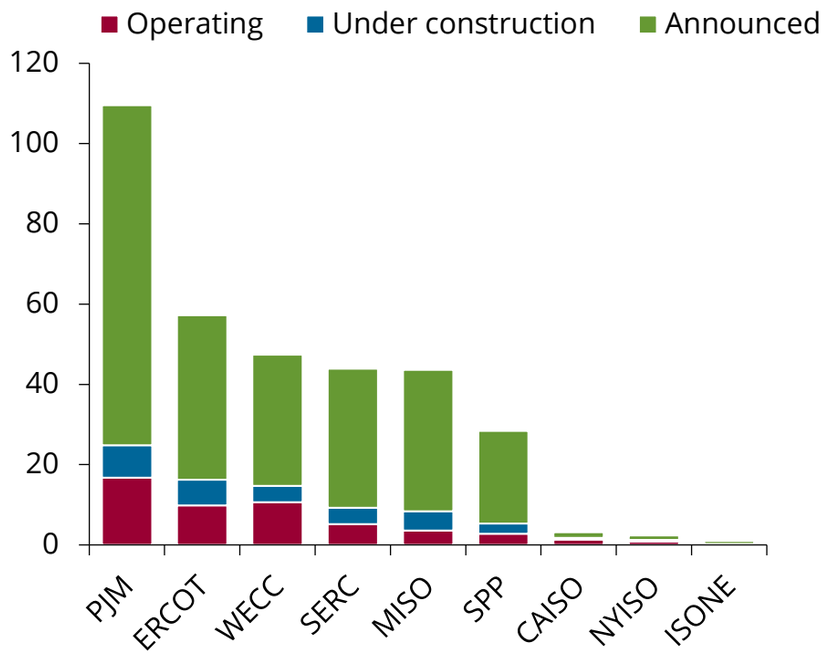
Note: BTM stands for behind-the-meter generation

Source: PJM, Baxtel, Energy Aspects

We raised SPP, MISO, non-ISO load; maintain stagnant CAISO, ISONE, NYISO growth

Tracked data centre nameplate capacity

GW



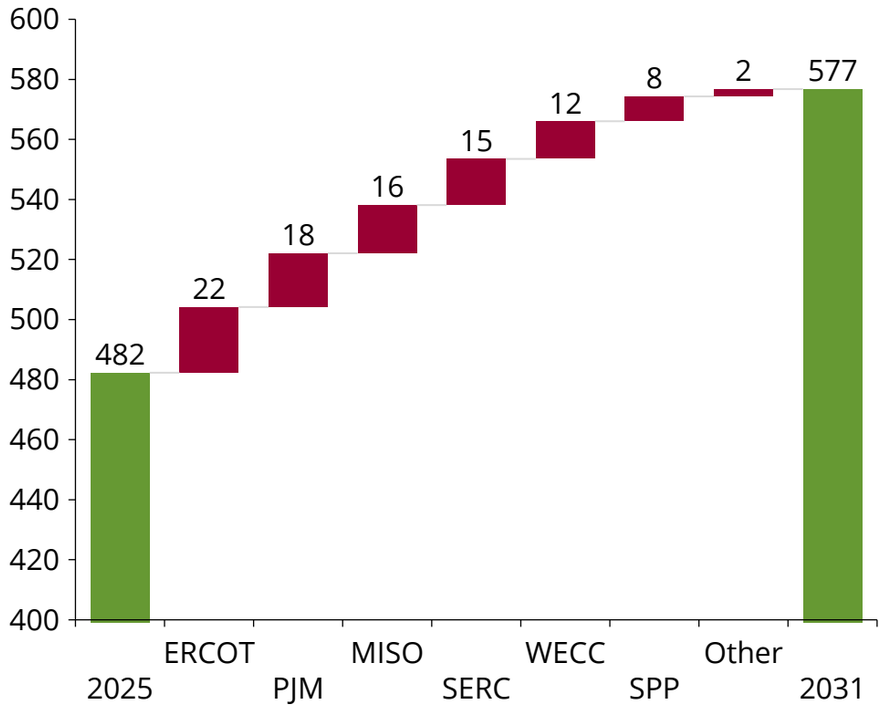
ERCOT and PJM continue to have a massive backlog of data-centre interest, but regulatory headwinds and capacity constraints have pushed development activity elsewhere.

Note: Excludes data centres with BTM generation

Source: Baxtel, Energy Aspects

Lower 48 weather-normalised load growth

GW

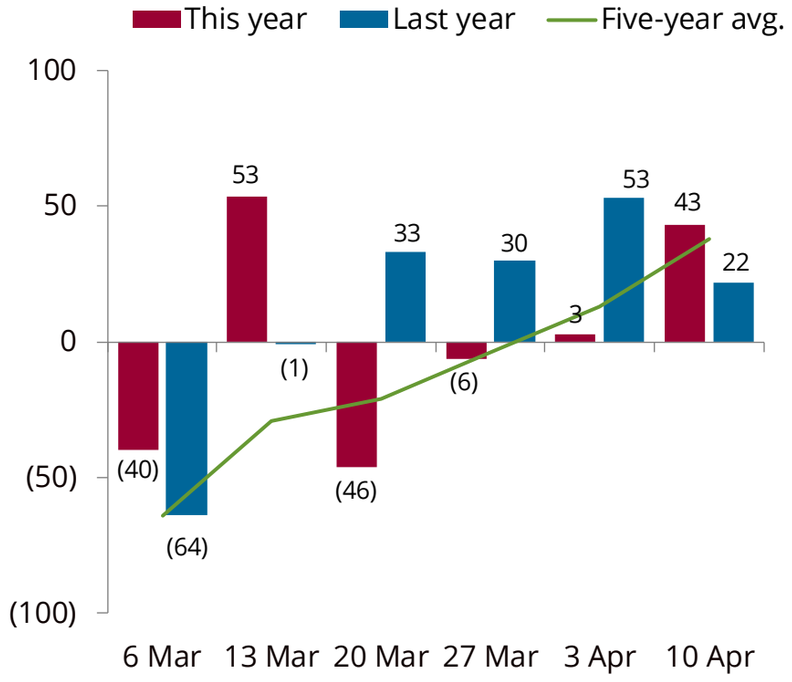


ERCOT and PJM still lead Lower 48 load growth through 2031, but MISO, SERC, WECC and SPP take a larger share. Other regions are stagnant, but data-centre activity is growing.

Lower 48 storage forecast

EIA weekly storage activity

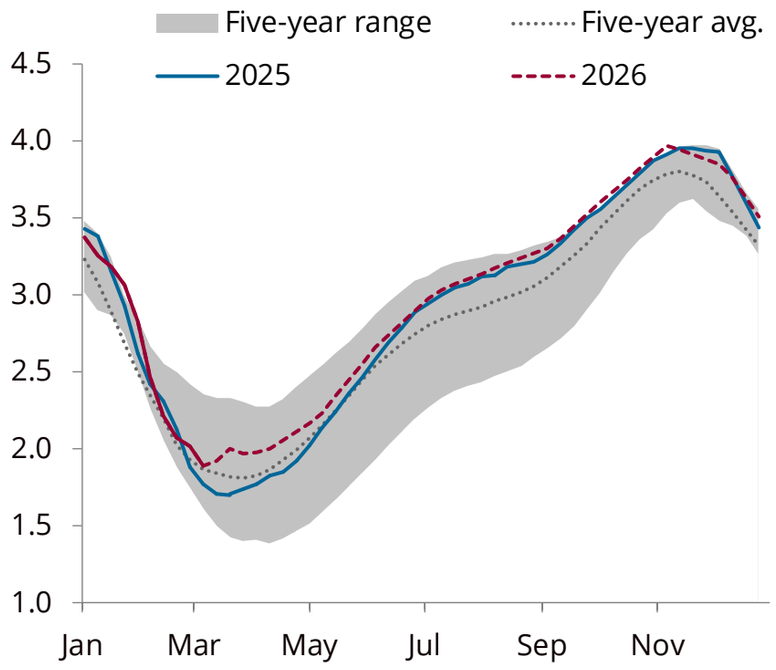
bcf



We estimate a 40 bcf withdrawal for Thursday's EIA report, as higher Lower 48 production (+1.0 bcf/d w/w) and declining res-com demand (-10.7 bcf/d w/w) loosen weekly balances.

US gas storage

tcf



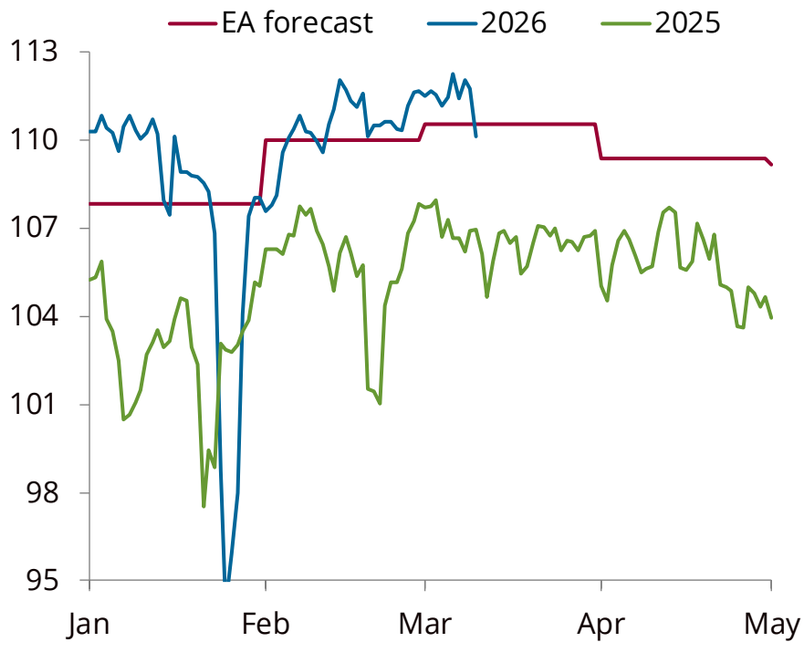
Our end-October storage estimate loosened further (+18 bcf w/w) to 3.85 tcf on resilient expectations for Lower 48 production (+2.9 bcf/d y/y) through the summer.

Source: EIA, Energy Aspects

Domestic gas production

Total dry-gas production

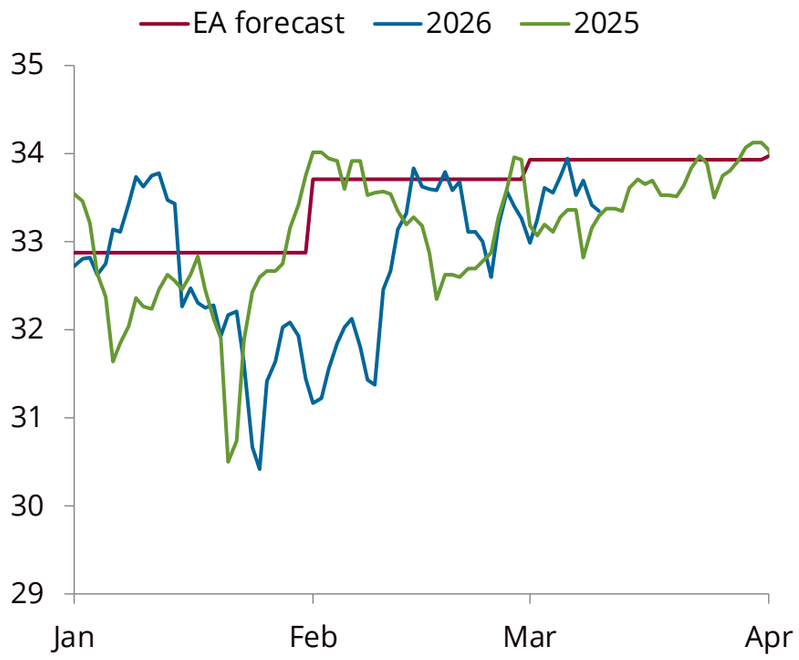
bcf/d



Our model shows Lower 48 production has fallen by 0.6 bcf/d w/w to average 110.9 bcf/d WTD, on Tuesday effect limiting weekly upside. Weekend flows peaked near 111.0 bcf/d.

Appalachian gas production

bcf/d



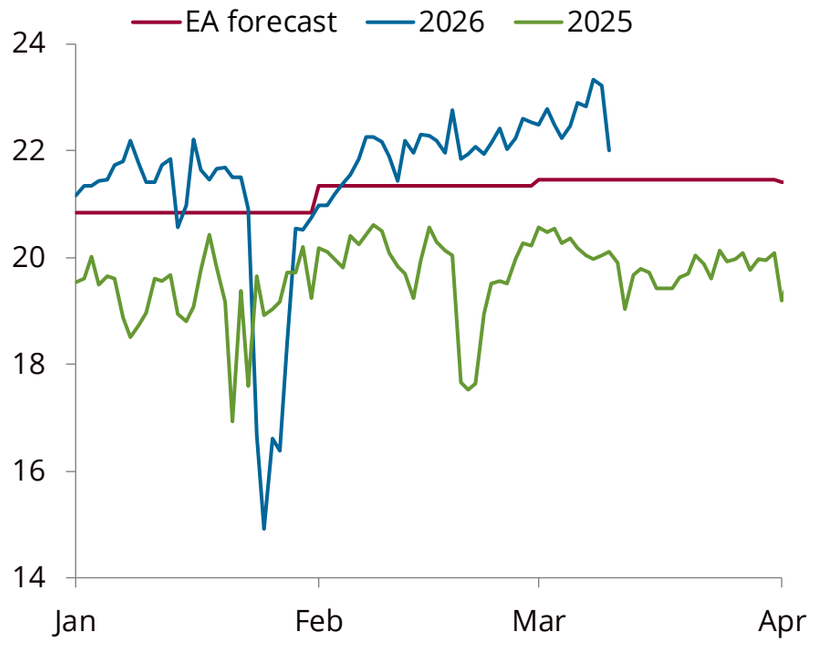
Appalachia flows average 33.4 bcf/d WTD, flat w/w, despite sub-regional NEPA flows averaging 10.9 bcf/d over the weekend, which is 0.2 bcf/d higher w/w.

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Domestic gas production – Permian and Haynesville

Permian gas production

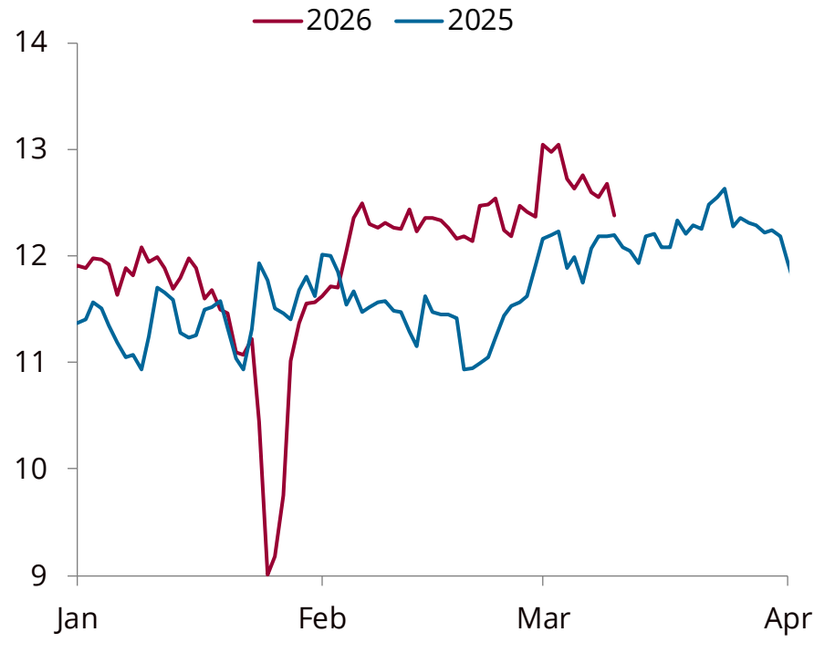
bcf/d



Permian flows average 22.6 bcf/d WTD, 0.1 bcf/d lower w/w as the Tuesday effect pushed early-cycle flows on 10 March below 22 bcf/d.

Haynesville gas production

bcf/d



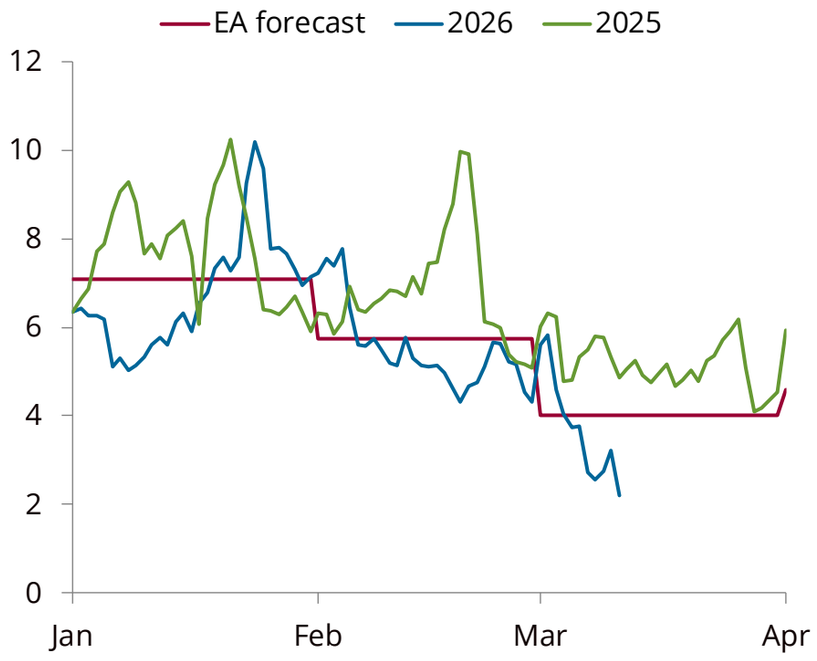
Our Haynesville sample averages 12.5 bcf/d WTD, 0.5 bcf/d lower w/w on erratic regional flows.

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Trade – Canada and Mexico

US imports from Canada

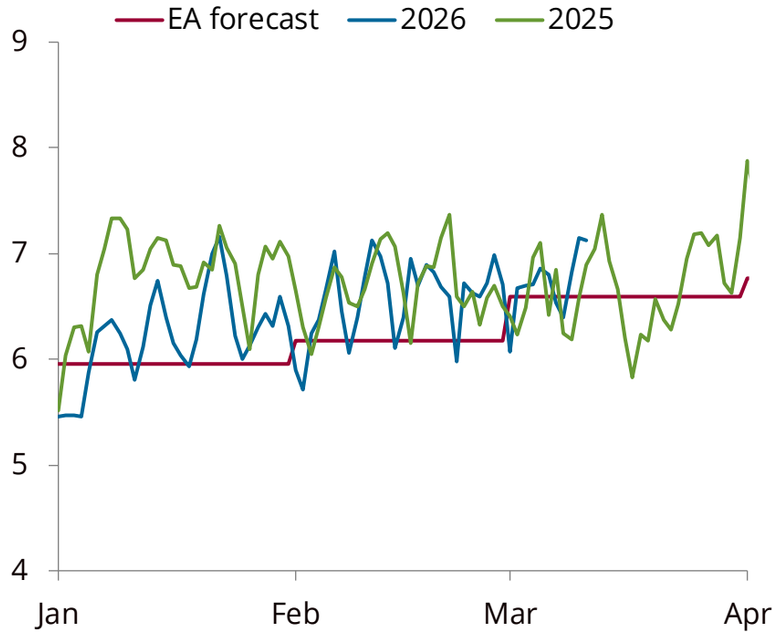
bcf/d



Imports from Canada have averaged 2.9 bcf/d WTD, 1.4 bcf/d lower w/w as weather demand has eroded and exports are still realising at all-time highs.

US exports to Mexico

bcf/d



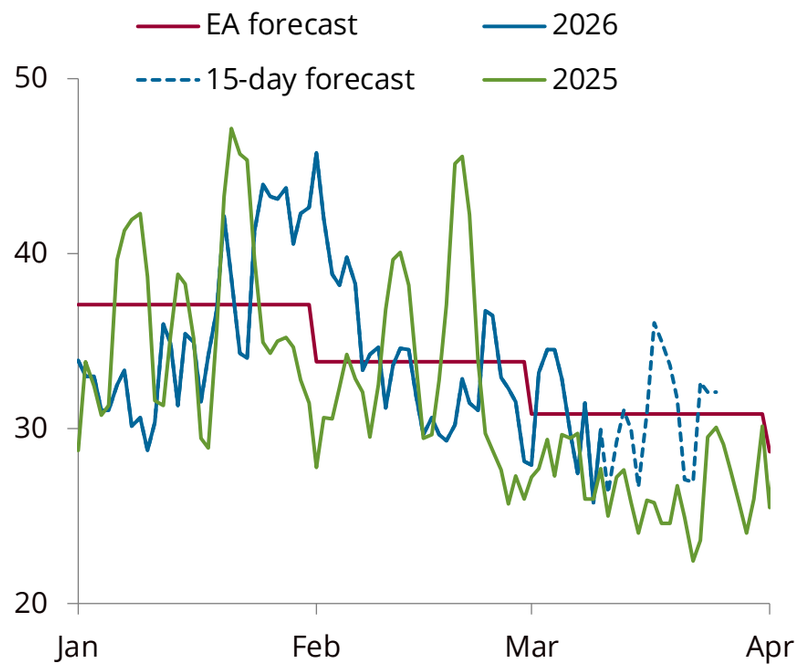
We have refined our Mexican trade model to include more flow points. Flows have increased by 0.2 bcf/d w/w to average 6.9 bcf/d WTD.

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Gas demand – Power and res-com

Power gas demand

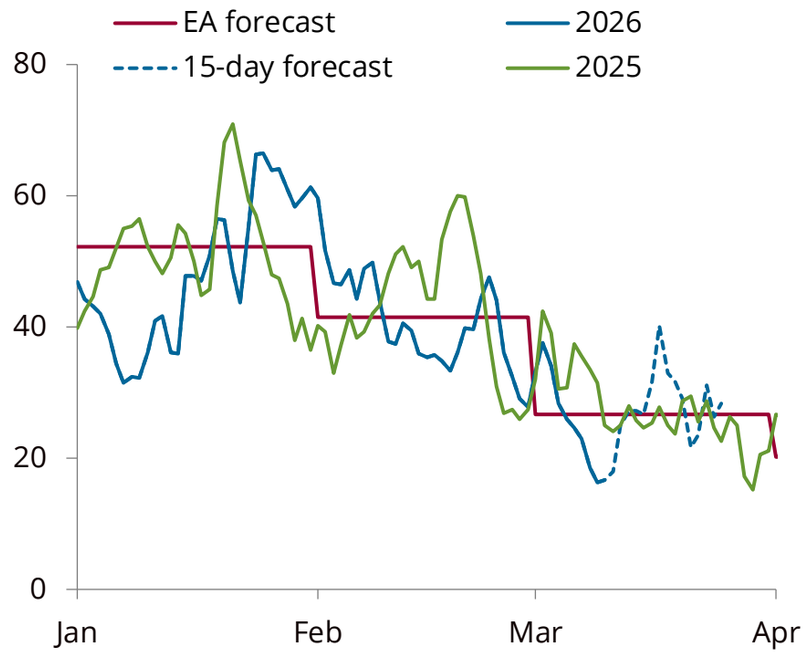
bcf/d



We estimate gas-for-power demand for the week ending 13 March will average 30.4 bcf/d, 2.9 bcf/d lower w/w.

Res-com demand

bcf/d



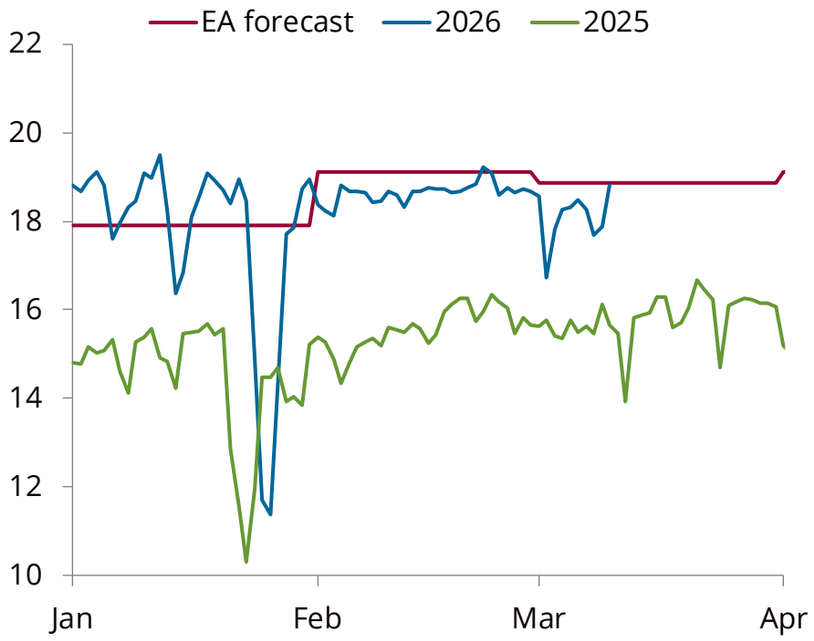
HDD attrition for the current week will lead to further declines (-10.7 bcf/d w/w) in res-com demand. We expect March res-com demand to average 26.6 bcf/d, 14.8 bcf/d lower m/m.

Source: Spire Weather, Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Gas demand – LNG feedgas

LNG feedgas demand

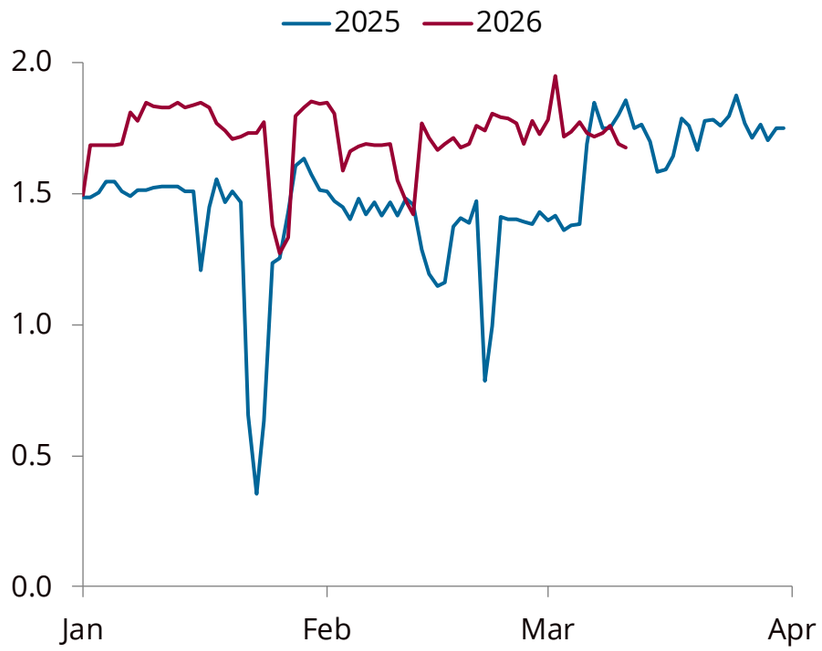
bcf/d



Visible LNG feedgas demand averages 18.3 bcf/d WTD, 1.0 bcf/d higher w/w as Cameron flows returned to baseline levels (from 2.2 to 2.0 bcf/d) late last week.

Calcasieu Pass feedgas demand

bcf/d



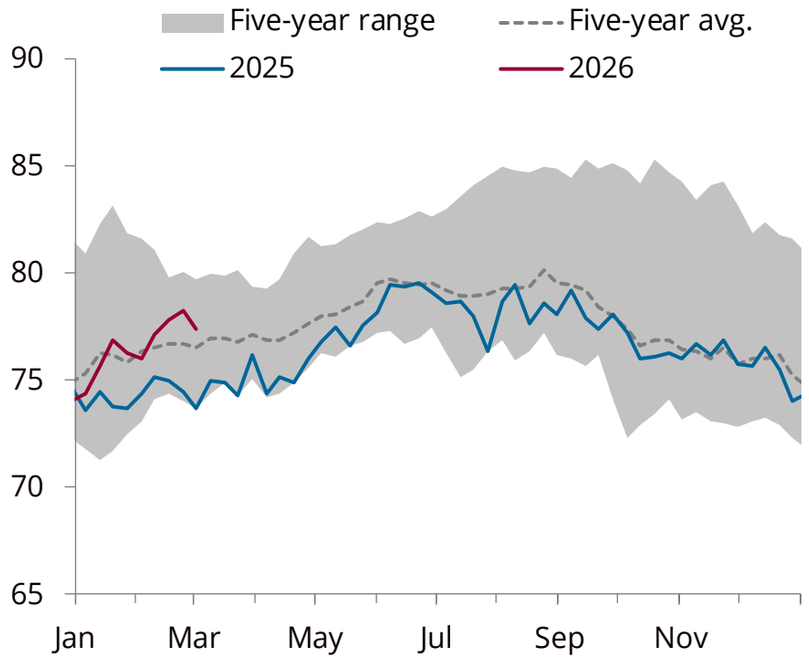
Calcasieu Pass feedgas has averaged 1.7 bcf/d QTD, 0.3 bcf/d higher y/y, and remains the largest contributor to near-record LNG capacity utilisation (97% for March).

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Industrial demand sectors – Steel and refining

US steel capacity utilisation

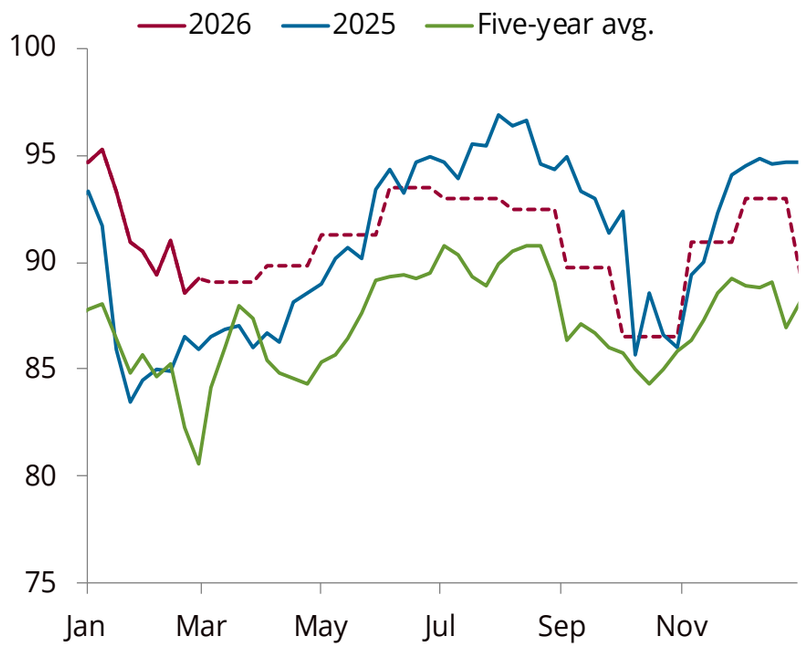
%



Steel capacity utilisation has fallen w/w, dropping by 0.9 ppts to 77.4%.

US refinery capacity utilisation

%



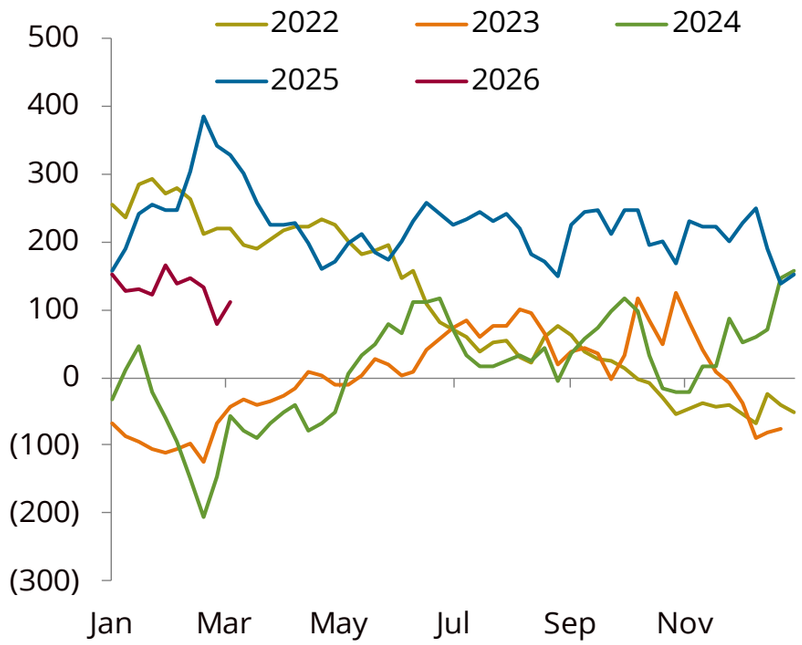
US refiners are least affected by the Iran conflict. Crude imports via the Strait of Hormuz account for just 3% of runs and have access to higher volumes of LatAm heavies.

Source: AISI, EIA, Energy Aspects

CFTC and rig counts

ICE, NYMEX net positioning

k lots



Net positioning rebounded w/w, again rising above 100k lots net long on geopolitical instability.

Rig counts for select US basins

rigs

	Gas		Oil		Total	
6 Mar 26	132		411		551	
w/w chg.	*(2)*	↓	*4*	↑	*1*	↑
y/y chg.	*32*	↑	*(76)*	↓	*(41)*	↓
27 Feb 26	134		407		550	
14 Mar 25	100		487		592	

	Appalachia		Haynesville		Permian	
6 Mar 26	39		53		241	
w/w chg.	*(1)*	↓	*1*	↑	*2*	↑
y/y chg.	*4*	↑	*24*	↑	*(60)*	↓
27 Feb 26	40		52		239	
14 Mar 25	35		29		301	

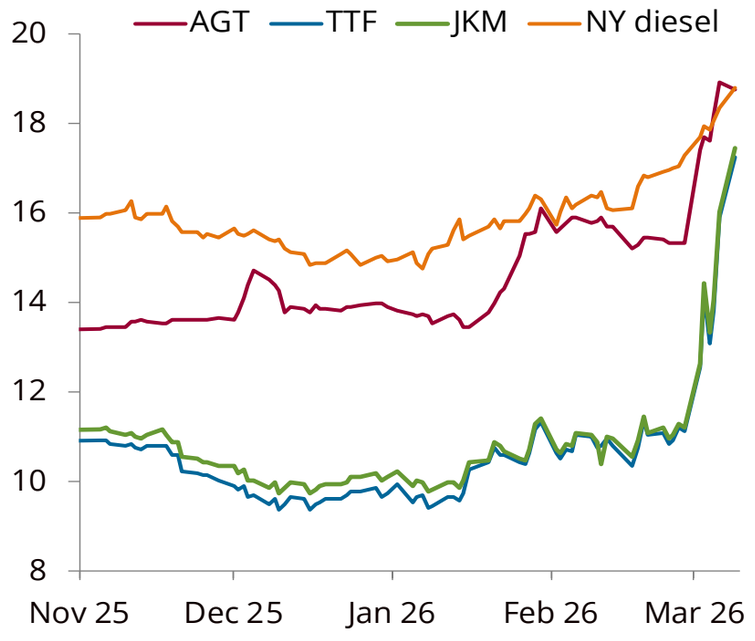
Appalachia lost one net rig in the Utica while the Haynesville gained yet another rig. Oil producers have not yet reacted to the upswing in crude prices with increased activity.

Source: Baker Hughes, Bloomberg, CFTC, ICE, Energy Aspects

AGT peak-winter 2027 forwards rally; Midwest import lines to see heavy maintenance

Jan-27–Feb-27 LNG, NY diesel forwards

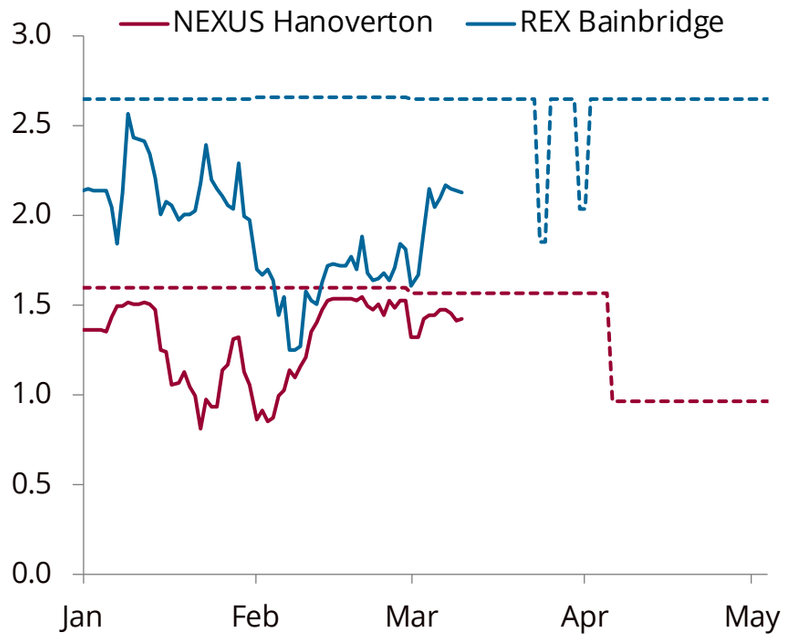
$/MMBtu



AGT FG-27 forwards remained elevated due to fuel inventory risks after Winter Storm Fern, but prices have rallied further on rising global LNG and oil prices due to the Iran conflict.

NEXUS, REX compressor capacities

bcf/d



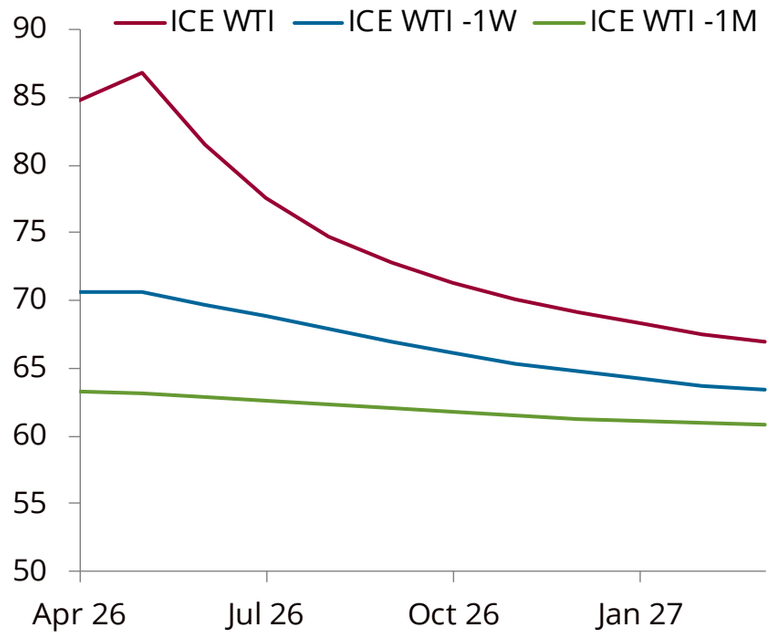
Appalachia export paths to the Midwest will undergo heavy maintenance. NEXUS's Hanoverton works will cut line capacity by 0.60 bcf/d to 1.56 bcf/d over 6 April–4 May.

Source: ICE, LSEG, pipeline notices, Ventyx, Energy Aspects

WTI forwards rally, but Permian production upside limited until H2 26

WTI forward curve

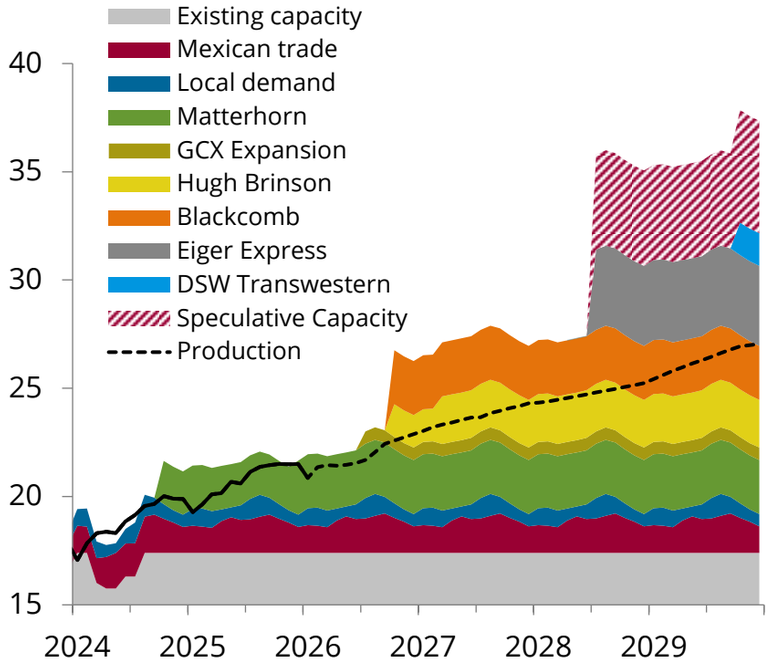
$/bbl



WTI futures have rallied sharply on geopolitical risks from the Iran conflict. Domestic producers are yet to raise oil rigs, but there is evidence of increased hedging, as well as shorting.

Permian takeaway capacity

bcf/d



Kinder Morgan's 0.6 bcf/d GCX expansion has been delayed into Q3 26, after which two new greenfield pipelines will enter service, unlocking Permian growth into 2027.

Source: ICE, company reports, EIA, Energy Aspects

Weather-normalised and peak-load growth

Weather-normalised load growth, y/y

%

	ISONE	NYISO	PJM	ERCOT	MISO	CAISO	SPP	US48
2027	0.6	0.9	3.2	6.0	2.6	0.6	4.0	3.5
2026	0.5	1.1	2.9	5.3	2.4	0.8	3.6	2.7
2025	(0.2)	0.1	2.4	5.9	2.2	(0.4)	3.7	2.5
Sep 26	0.3	1.5	3.4	5.4	2.5	1.0	4.2	3.1
Aug 26	0.2	1.1	2.6	4.9	2.4	0.6	3.2	2.9
Jul 26	(0.2)	0.9	3.3	5.0	2.4	0.6	3.5	3.1
Jun 26	0.4	1.8	3.0	5.4	3.0	0.7	4.0	3.1
May 26	(0.7)	0.6	2.8	6.1	2.5	0.6	4.3	2.5
Apr 26	0.6	1.4	3.0	7.1	2.8	0.1	4.8	3.1
Mar 26	0.9	1.3	3.3	5.6	2.9	1.5	3.7	3.5
Feb 26	2.3	0.4	3.2	1.2	1.4	1.0	0.9	1.7
Jan 26	2.2	0.7	1.4	2.2	0.5	1.2	2.2	0.1
Dec 25	0.1	(0.7)	1.8	3.8	1.8	0.4	5.1	1.5
Nov 25	(0.5)	(0.1)	2.7	4.2	(0.1)	(2.3)	4.8	1.4
Oct 25	(0.1)	(0.6)	3.6	5.6	1.5	0.2	3.1	2.8

Peak load, peak-load growth, y/y

%, GW

Season	Year	ISONE	NYISO	PJM	ERCOT	MISO	CAISO	US48
Summer (%)	**2027**	1.7	(0.9)	3.2	3.6	2.9	1.4	2.6
	2026	2.7	1.6	4.9	4.1	5.0	(0.4)	3.2
	2025	1.6	(2.8)	2.0	4.4	1.1	0.1	1.7
Winter (%)	**2027**	0.4	0.7	5.0	5.3	3.1	1.7	4.7
	2026	2.1	1.2	1.5	(0.8)	0.6	(0.4)	(0.0)
	2025	0.6	0.7	0.9	3.2	1.2	(1.1)	0.4
Summer (GW)	**2027**	25.9	31.2	171.4	97.3	132.1	48.1	793.1
	2026	25.5	31.5	166.2	93.9	128.3	47.4	773.4
	2025	24.8	31.0	158.4	90.2	122.2	47.6	749.7
Winter (GW)	**2027**	20.9	25.5	153.0	84.3	108.2	32.1	709.8
	2026	20.9	25.4	145.7	80.0	104.9	31.5	677.7
	2025	20.4	25.1	143.5	80.7	104.3	31.6	678.0

Our weather-normalised load model is likely understating PJM gains y/y in January and February, as historic cold weather during this period complicates the load disaggregation.

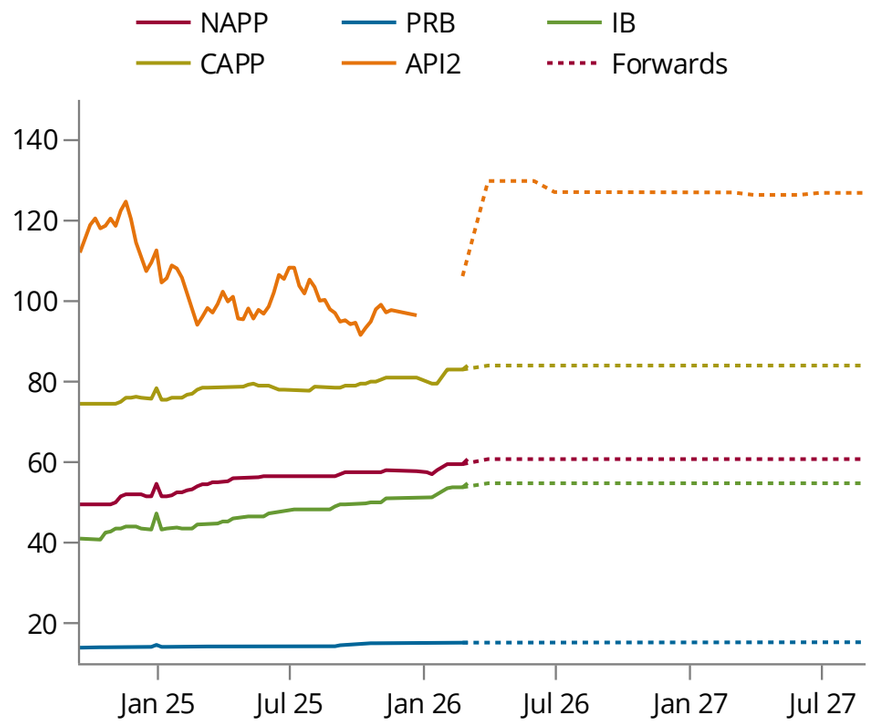
We expect winter peak load will grow faster than summer peak load in PJM due to heating electrification and BTM solar generation.

Source: ISOs, Energy Aspects

Coal prices and production

Coal prices

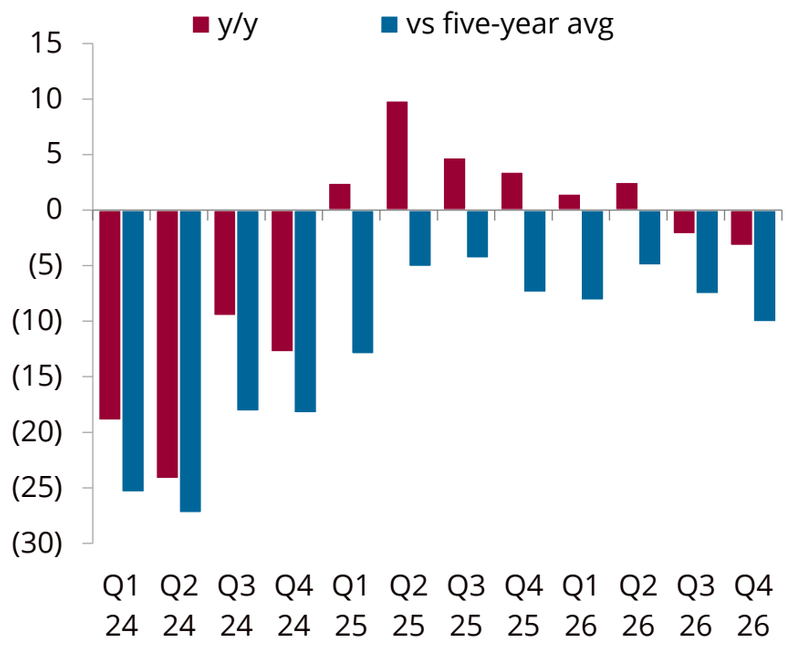
$/t



Healthy domestic coal stocks and limited upside to European coal generation will keep the call on US exports and coal prices stable, unless the Iran conflict persists through spring.

Lower 48 coal production

Mt



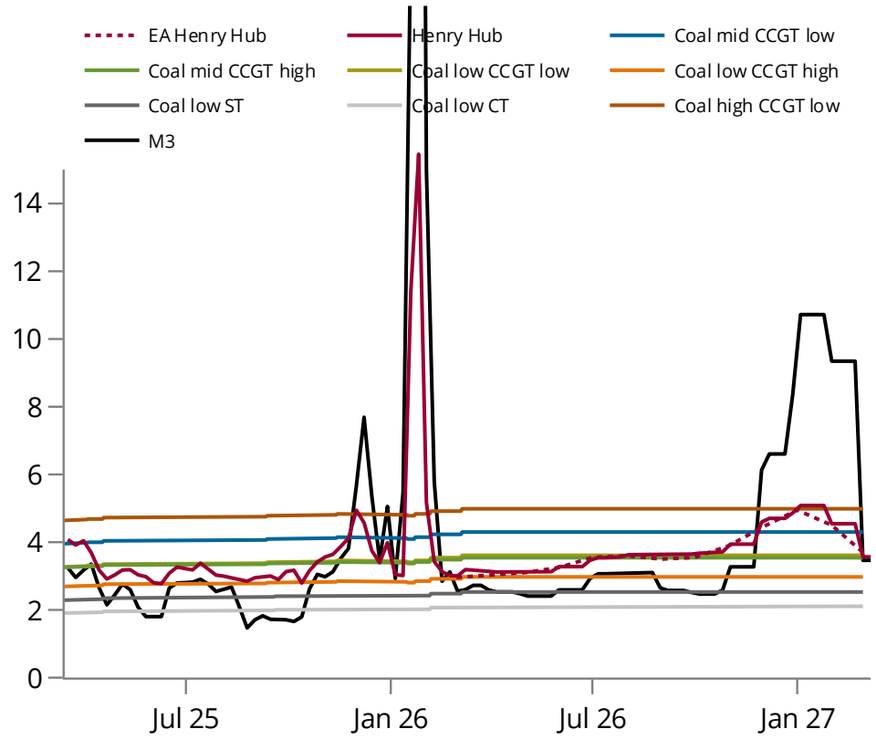
We forecast flat-to-slightly-lower production y/y, as generator inventories will remain near generator target levels at least through summer under normal weather.

Source: Coaldesk, EIA, Energy Aspects

PJM fuel switching, outages

PJM fuel-switching curves

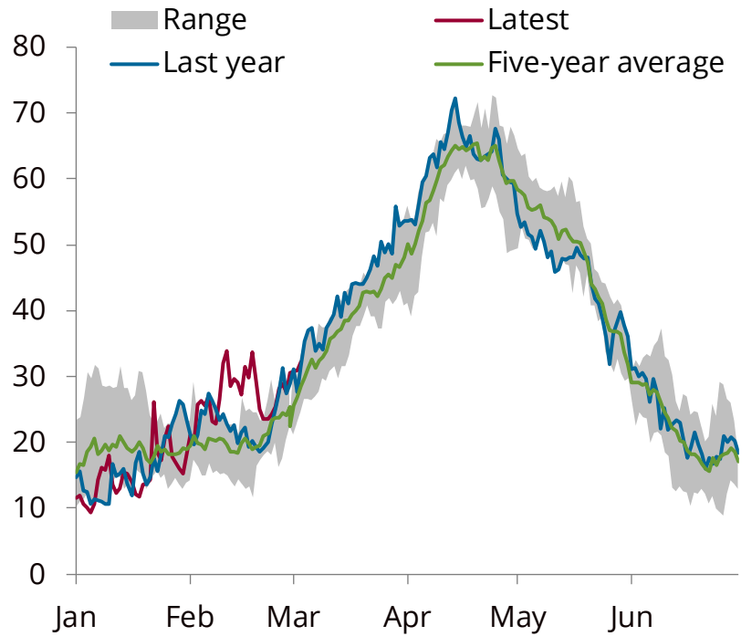
$/MMBtu



M3 forwards currently put most gas in merit against coal this spring despite a slight rise in NAPP coal prices.

PJM generator outages

GW



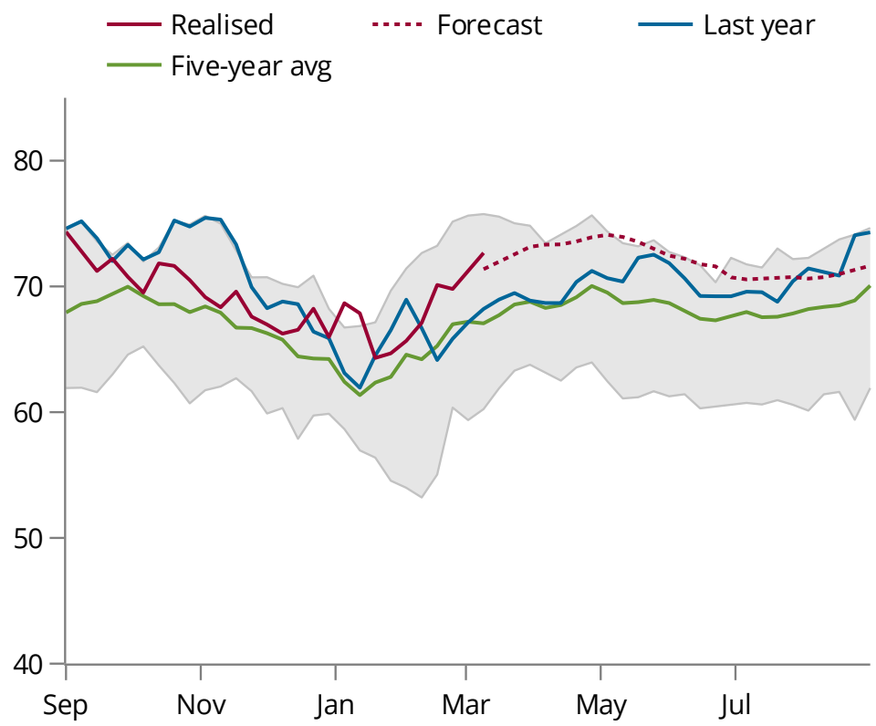
Outages have begun to rise as above-normal temperatures are expected this month and generators that deferred maintenance in February can take outage.

Source: ICE, NRC, PJM, Energy Aspects

Gas generation

US gas share of thermal generation

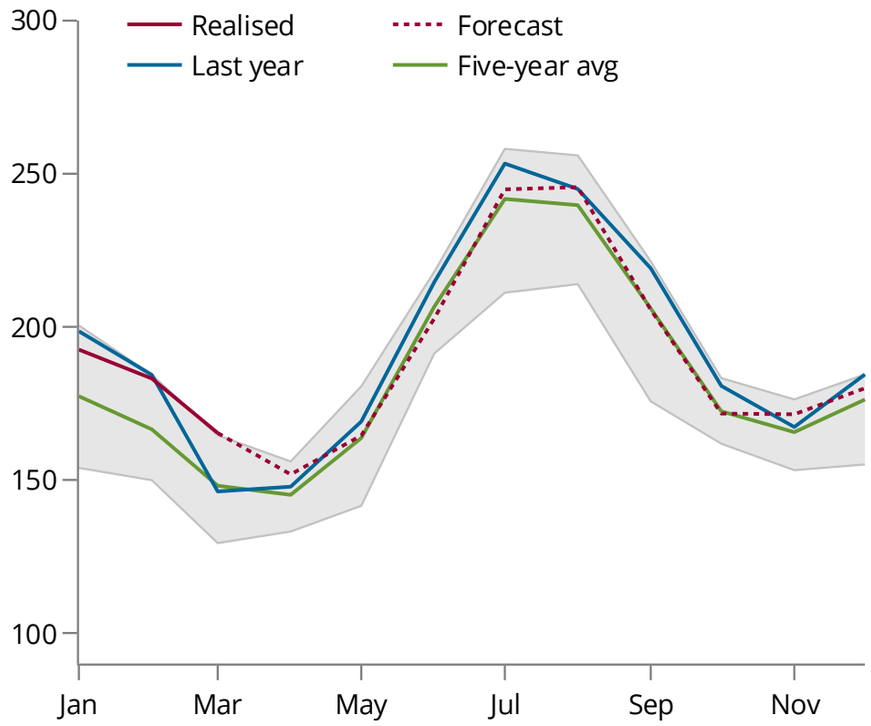
%



Warm weather runs combined with cheaper gas prices have increased our gas-share expectations above 70% through the shoulder season.

US gas generation

GW



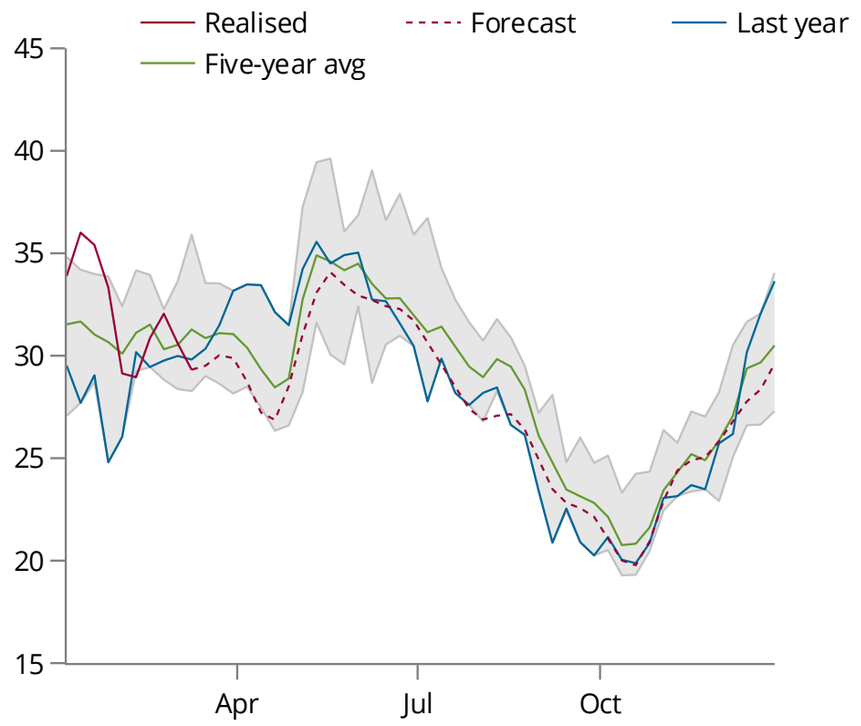
We expect April gas generation to increase by over 4 GW y/y as prompt Henry Hub prices remain $1/MMBtu lower y/y. The rise in gas prices w/w will reduce burns by about 0.3 bcf/d.

Source: EIA, Energy Aspects

Power generation

US hydro generation

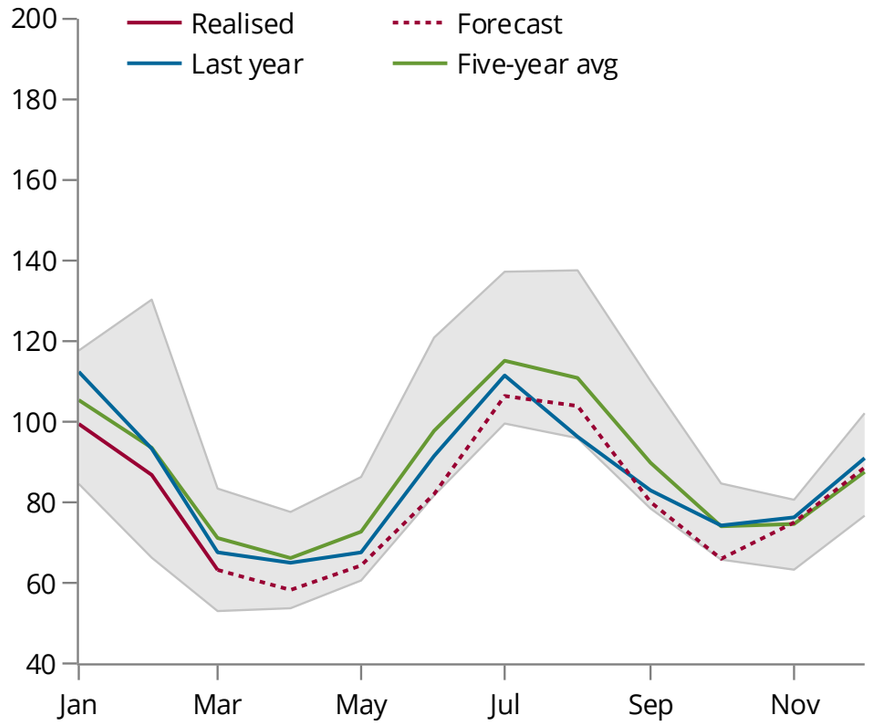
GW



US West precipitation has been near the 20-year average, driving reservoir replenishment. Ultimate generation levels are uncertain as the ratio of water to snow is unprecedented.

US coal generation

GW



We expect coal generation to realise over 6 GW lower y/y for April on lower Henry Hub prices y/y.

Source: EIA, Energy Aspects

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